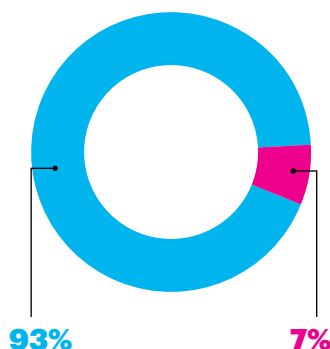


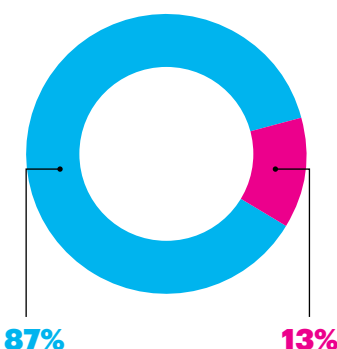
A Yawning Gap

► Women's participation in the top management of tech firms is far less than their male counterparts

EXECUTIVE-LEVEL POSITIONS

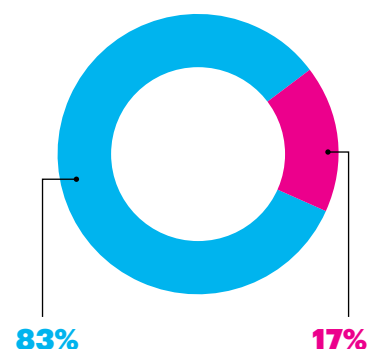


DIRECTOR-LEVEL POSITIONS



► Women's share in leadership goes down as you go higher up in a company's hierarchy

MID-LEVEL MANAGER POSITIONS



● MEN ● WOMEN

WOMEN'S PARTICIPATION IN MANAGEMENT **SOURCE** SKILLSOFT'S 2022 WOMEN IN TECH REPORT INDIA REGION

restricted to big tech firms. Even the new-age start-up ecosystem is grappling with the dismal participation of women. Avaali's Kannan says one reason for this concerning trend is the lack of funding available to women-founded start-ups. She says, "Limited access to funding and resources for female-led start-ups and businesses continues to contribute to the under-representation of women in leadership positions".

Kavita Gupta, Founder and Managing Partner of Delta Blockchain Fund, concurs. Citing the example of her current fund that supports 50-odd companies, she says that less than 10 per cent of those have female founders. She explains that while on the one hand, not many women-led start-ups receive the required funding, on the other, there are

only a handful of funds being run by female investors. "The ratios are extremely skewed. This is because limited partners, be it family offices, endowment funds, institutional investors, sovereign wealth funds, etc., are not confident enough to let women lead VC funds. This mindset has to change as this would bring about a change in the whole ecosystem."

According to a report from Harvard Business Review, start-ups founded solely by women receive less than 3 per cent of all venture capital investments, while less than 15 per cent of the cheque-writers in VC investing are women. While funding for women-led start-ups and the minuscule number of women VC investors are structural issues that need to be dealt with on a much larger scale, there's another

aspect of how biases against women creep into the development of emerging technologies and impact the lives of women. It's visible in the increasing usage of artificial intelligence and machine learning algorithms that have been found to be discriminating against women. An example is the usage of AI algorithms by Amazon earlier to sort through resumes for its tech recruiting process. Over time, the company found that the algorithm preferred male sounding names over female sounding names, which showcased a clear bias.

Jaspreet Bindra, Founder and MD of tech advisory Tech Whisperer, says the reason AI algorithms give such results is because of the data they are trained on. "The AI had learnt from data of Amazon's past recruits, who were mostly